

TALK TO ME DATA

The Automate-by-Friday checklist

18 everyday tasks most small businesses still do by hand, and what changes the moment an AI agent takes them off your plate.

```
$ scanning daily operations...  
> checking sales, support, scheduling,  
admin, marketing  
> manual tasks found: 18  
> recommendation: automate ✓
```



Most businesses aren't understaffed. They're under-automated.

Every business has a running list of tasks nobody loves doing, but everybody keeps doing anyway: answering the same questions, chasing the same follow-ups, retyping the same information from one place to another. None of it takes a person's judgment. All of it takes a person's time.

The businesses pulling ahead right now aren't necessarily working harder or hiring faster. **They've quietly handed the repetitive parts of their day to an AI agent:** software that handles a task start to finish, the same way every time, at any hour, without needing to be reminded, trained or managed.

This guide is a simple, honest audit. The next few pages list 18 common tasks across sales, support, scheduling, admin and marketing. Tick the box for anything your business still does by hand today. By the end, you'll see exactly where your team's time is going, and where it doesn't have to.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- 01 Check the box next to anything you or your team still do manually today.
- 02 Don't overthink it. If it's even partly manual, check it.
- 03 Add up your checkmarks and read your result on the last checklist page.

01

Sales and lead
response

02

Customer
support

03

Scheduling
and operations

04

Admin and
back office

05

Marketing and
retention



01 Sales and lead response

4 ITEMS

- ☐ **New website inquiries sit in an inbox until someone's free**
Every minute between "they reached out" and "someone replied" is a minute a competitor could get there first.
- ☐ **The same qualifying questions get asked manually, every time**
Budget, timeline, needs: typed out (or said out loud) one lead at a time, by a person.
- ☐ **Leads who don't convert immediately rarely hear from you again**
With no consistent follow-up, warm leads quietly go cold. Nobody notices until they've booked with someone else.
- ☐ **Pricing and quote info gets typed out fresh for every inquiry**
Even when the answer is basically the same every time, someone still has to write it out.

02 Customer support

4 ITEMS

- ☐ **The same FAQs get answered over and over**
Hours, location, pricing, policies: questions your team could recite in their sleep, asked again by someone new every day.
- ☐ **"Where's my order?" and "When's my appointment?" calls tie up staff time**
A two-minute status check interrupts whatever your team was actually trying to focus on.
- ☐ **Simple support requests wait in the same queue as everything else**
A password reset and a serious complaint land in the same inbox, with the same "we'll get to it."
- ☐ **Anything that comes in after hours waits until tomorrow**
Including the customer who was ready to buy, book or sign tonight.

WHAT THIS LOOKS LIKE WITH AN AGENT

A **Lead Qualification Agent** replies to new inquiries in seconds, asks your standard questions, and sends only the leads that are ready to talk straight to your inbox.

A **Customer Support Agent** handles FAQs, order status and basic requests around the clock, every day, and passes anything it can't resolve to your team.

03 Scheduling and operations

4 ITEMS

- ☐ **Booking a call or appointment takes several back-and-forth messages**
"Does Tuesday work?" "What time?" "Actually, can we do Thursday instead?" That's a five-message thread for one booking.
- ☐ **No-shows happen because reminders are inconsistent**
Or they don't go out at all, and the slot just sits empty.
- ☐ **Reschedules and cancellations are handled one at a time, manually**
Each one becomes its own little fire to put out, in between everything else.
- ☐ **Staff cross-check multiple calendars just to confirm availability**
Before anyone can even answer "are you free Thursday?"

04 Admin and back office

3 ITEMS

- ☐ **Invoices and payment reminders go out manually, and sometimes late**
Nobody loves chasing payments, so it's the first thing that slips when the week gets busy.
- ☐ **New client information gets typed in by hand**
From a form, an email or a phone call into whatever system actually runs the business.
- ☐ **CRM records get updated "when there's time"**
Which, realistically, means they're usually a few weeks out of date.



WHAT THIS LOOKS LIKE WITH AN AGENT

A **Booking & Scheduling Agent** lets clients self-book, reschedule and get reminders, synced to your real calendar, with zero back-and-forth.

The same agent can update your CRM and send an invoice the moment a job or appointment is marked complete. No extra typing.

05 Marketing and retention

3 ITEMS

- ☐ **Review requests are an afterthought, or skipped entirely**
Happy customers rarely leave a review unless someone asks, at the right moment, every time.
- ☐ **Past customers go quiet because no one follows up**
They liked working with you. They just haven't thought about you since.
- ☐ **Recap notes and follow-ups after calls get written from scratch**
Every single time: same structure, same effort, different name at the top.

Add up your checkmarks

There's no wrong score here. It's just a clearer picture of where your team's hours go each week.

0–5

CHECKED

You're leaner than most

Your operations are tighter than average. The few items you checked are still worth a closer look, since they tend to be the ones that quietly eat the most time.

6–11

CHECKED

Your team is spending real hours on work that doesn't need a person

This is the most common range. Each task feels small on its own. Together, they add up to a real chunk of every week that could go toward growth instead.

12–18

CHECKED

Your business is running a second, unpaid employee made of busywork

This is exactly the kind of work an AI agent is built for: well defined, repetitive and soaking up hours you could spend on customers, sales or simply going home on time.

Whatever you checked, an AI agent can probably take it off your plate.

You don't need to figure out the tech, hire a developer or manage another piece of software. Sign up free, tell us the job in plain English, and we build and run the agent for you.

01

Sign up free

Create your account. Free to start, no code.

02

Describe the job

Tell us what you checked, in your own words. No specs needed.

03

Your agent goes live

We host it and keep it working. You approve what it does and can change it any time.

Get Started →

Free to start · No code · You stay in control · app.talktomedata.com/signup

